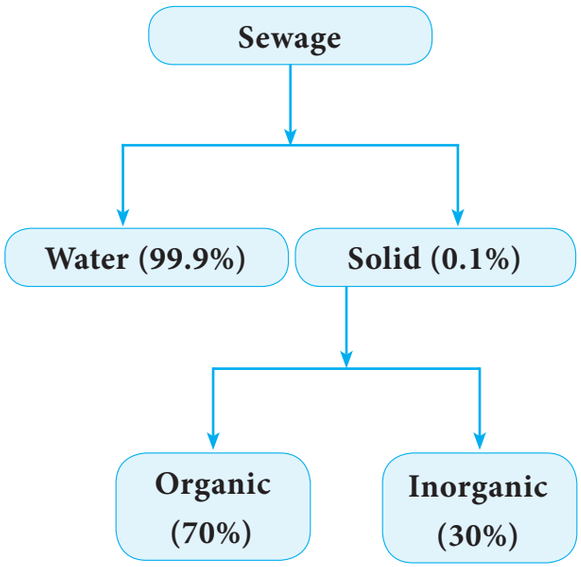
drinking, swimming, or fishing. Water pollution is caused primarily by the drainage of contaminated wastewater into surface water or groundwater. The wastewater treatment is a major element of water pollution control.



Goal of Sewage Treatment

- To convert waste water into a reusable resources.
- To reduce the spread of pathogenic microorganisms
- To avoid health hazards while swimming and boating in the water.
- To prevent the development of objectionable colours and tastes

The predominant method of wastewater disposal in large cities and towns is discharge into a body of surface water. Suburban and rural areas rely more on subsurface disposal. In either case, wastewater must be purified or treated to some degree in order to protect both public health and water quality. Suspended particulates and biodegradable organics must be removed to varying extents. Pathogenic bacteria must be destroyed. It may also be necessary to remove nitrates, phosphates (plant nutrients) to neutralize or remove industrial wastes and toxic chemicals. The degree to which wastewater must be treated varies, depending on local environmental conditions and governmental standards.

HOTS

List the major oil spills that occurred recently in India and other countries. Is it practically possible to clean up these oil spills using bacteria?



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